

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 54

By Barrett

A RESOLUTION to recognize Lewis County Sheriff Dwayne Kilpatrick on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in law enforcement; and

WHEREAS, Dwayne Kilpatrick of the Lewis County Sheriff's Office is one such estimable individual, who has devoted his life to the preservation of law and order and the protection of his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, after a forty-three-year career in law enforcement, Sheriff Kilpatrick recently took his much-deserved retirement on December 31, 2024, having devoted thirteen years of his life to public service and law enforcement as sheriff of Lewis County; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from Lewis County High School in 1978, Dwayne Kilpatrick enlisted in the United States Navy, proudly serving his country while exemplifying the values of honor, courage, and commitment; and

WHEREAS, it was during his military service that he developed a deep sense of duty and the desire to protect and serve others; upon leaving the Navy in 1981, he returned to Lewis County and joined the Hohenwald Police Department; and

WHEREAS, over the next thirteen years, Dwayne Kilpatrick devoted himself to serving the people of Hohenwald, proving himself to be an officer of the highest order; he earned the respect of his peers and fellow citizens alike for his work ethic, integrity, professionalism, and leadership skills; and

WHEREAS, he made a successful bid for the office of Lewis County Sheriff in 1994, ultimately being elected to the post an additional seven consecutive times, making him the

longest-serving sheriff in the county's history; he also became one of Lewis County's most beloved elected officials during his time in office; and

WHEREAS, throughout his three decades as sheriff, Sheriff Kilpatrick met each challenge with unwavering resolve and compassion; his leadership transformed the Lewis County Sheriff's Department and fostered a sense of trust and collaboration between law enforcement and the public; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Dwayne Kilpatrick successfully operated a work-release program for decades, through which supervised trustees assisted with various community projects, including mowing cemeteries, cleaning up the ball park, and providing assistance to county and city workers; and

WHEREAS, as sheriff, he spearheaded the wood program, in which inmates would cut unwanted trees throughout the county, haul the wood back to the jail, and give the wood away to those individuals who were low-income, elderly, or disabled; this program has kept thousands of Lewis County families warm during the winter when they had no other sources of heat; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Kilpatrick's legacy also includes dedication to mentoring new officers as well as participation in countless community initiatives, including volunteering to serve on the Lewis County Senior Citizens Board and the E-911 Board of Directors; and

WHEREAS, he also served for many years as a director on the Victim Offender Reconciliation Program and sat on numerous committees within the Tennessee Sheriff's Association; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, Sheriff Kilpatrick has been blessed with the love and support of his wife, Trina; their children, Landon Kilpatrick, Maleah (Brad) Askins, and Kacey (Brenton) Atkins; and their grandchildren, Braylen, Mahaley, and Harrison; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Dwayne Kilpatrick brought honor to the office of sheriff, a most fitting station that recognized his devotion to the safety and preservation of his community; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Kilpatrick exemplifies the values of hard work, compassion, and devotion to community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean and diligent officer of the law; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, he demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the respect and admiration of his colleagues and the citizens of Lewis County; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor Lewis County Sheriff Dwayne Kilpatrick on the occasion of his retirement, commend his many years of distinguished service, and wish him continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.